PERKALATE / SPORTS TEAMS

The Matchday Rewards Playbook: Sponsor Funded Perks for Verified Fans

A step by step playbook for letting sponsors fund rewards for verified fans at the stadium, on days with no game, and online.

If your sponsors want proof and your fans want to be recognized, a reward program paid for by sponsors can serve both. Here is a practical way to set one up for a season, whatever tools you use today.

Step 1: Define who counts as a verified fan

Decide the eligibility rules before you talk to a single sponsor. Common tiers:

- Season ticket members
- Registered fans who bought a ticket in the last twelve months
- Members of your official fan club or supporters' group

Keep it simple. Two or three tiers is plenty. The point is that every reward goes to someone with a real connection to the team, and that the rule can be checked with a plain yes or no.

Step 2: Match each sponsor to a moment

Generic offers get generic results. Pair each sponsor with a moment where the reward makes sense:

- A beverage partner funds a reward redeemed at concessions during the first home game of the month.
- A local restaurant funds a reward for fans on the way to or from the venue.
- A retail partner funds an online reward that unlocks the morning after a win.
- Any partner funds a reward at the venue on a day with no game, such as a stadium tour, a team store event or a watch party.

Those off days matter. Your venue sits quiet for much of the year, and a reward tied to the venue in its off hours gives fans a reason to show up when there's no ticket to buy.

Step 3: Make consent the entry point

Explain what information is used to check eligibility. Ask fans to opt in before the check, and give the sponsor aggregate results.

Step 4: Keep the reward in the fan's pocket

Rewards that live in an email get lost. Rewards that live in the phone's wallet get used. Put the reward where fans already keep tickets and cards, and make redemption work both in person and online so a fan who can't make the next game still benefits.

Step 5: Agree on reporting before launch

Tell every sponsor up front what they'll see: how many eligible fans viewed the reward, how many claimed it and how many redeemed it. Aggregate counts, no names. Settling this early avoids the scramble for numbers at the end of the season, and the pressure to share fan data later.

Step 6: Rotate and retire

Run each reward for a defined window, usually a homestand or a month. Retire the ones that don't get claimed and give that slot to a different sponsor or a different moment. A rotating lineup keeps fans checking back and gives your partnership team fresh inventory to sell.

A sample season plan

- **Preseason:** Set eligibility tiers, pick three sponsors for a pilot, agree on reporting.
- **First month:** One reward per sponsor, each tied to a specific moment.
- **Midseason:** Review viewed, claimed and redeemed counts. Cut the weakest reward, expand the strongest.
- **Late season:** Add a reward at the venue on an off day to bridge the gap between home games.
- **Offseason:** Bring the results to renewal conversations.

Plan a pilot

Choose one audience, one reward and one result to measure. Set the budget and eligibility rules before launch. Tell participants which information you need and share results in aggregate where possible.